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GABY LUONG
Product Designer

PROFILE

I'm a Product Designer with graphic roots, and I help teams turn complex, messy products into systems people trust and use. Over 11 years across UX/UI, product design, and design systems, including 4 years running my own practice and over 3 years in-house at MDPI, I've shaped design direction, UX research, and mentored designers across international teams in Switzerland, the UK, and the Netherlands. My print background shows up in how I build scalable, Figma-based design systems that keep complex products coherent, and in how closely I work with engineering to ship them.

CORE SKILLS

UX Research · Product Design · Design Systems · Interactive Prototyping · Customer Journey Mapping · Usability Testing · Stakeholder Management · Cross-Functional Collaboration · Accessibility · Data-Informed Design · AI Tools

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MDPI: Product Designer in Basel | May 2022 – October 2025

- Co-built MDPI's UX & Research team, growing it to four people, and embedded user-centred design practices across complex, API-driven platforms serving 55+ million monthly users.
- Translated complex technical requirements and data models into intuitive, user-friendly interfaces, addressing edge cases and reducing friction across core user journeys through workflow restructuring.
- Established UX standards, research processes, and design-review practices across multiple products to strengthen design quality and cross-functional alignment.
- Facilitated workshops and training sessions for Product, Engineering, Data/AI, and business stakeholders to align on product direction and design decisions.
- Coached designers across international teams, supporting their growth in UX research and design-system practice.

Redesign MDPI Books: Product Designer | 2023 – 2024

- Directed the end-to-end redesign of MDPI's academic publishing platform, building interactive prototypes that served as functional specifications for engineering implementation.
- Increased traffic threefold and reduced homepage drop-off from 83% to 22% within 6 months through iterative, data-informed design decisions, based on 7 interviews with academics and researchers.
- Established platform structure and component library in close collaboration with product managers and engineers.

SciProfiles / Scilit: UX Research & Concept | 2024

- Conceptualized and scaled an international research platform for 1.1+ million users, built on an API-driven architecture in collaboration with engineering.
- Developed personas, customer journeys, and hypothesis-led product decisions in collaboration with AI and engineering teams.
- Facilitated international workshops to align distributed cross-functional teams and define product strategy.

MDPI User Hub: UX Research | 2025

- Led UX research to understand why users left Susy, MDPI's highest-revenue product, right after login despite an NPS of about 50.
- Analysed usage data and mapped the customer journey with 2 personas, finding that 1 in 4 visits ended right after login.
- Facilitated seven moderated interviews with researchers, triangulating quantitative and qualitative data into 6 key behavioural patterns.
- Shaped a unified, role-aware dashboard concept and produced low-fidelity wireframes as the foundation for User Hub's design direction.

Unified Design System for MDPI: Brand/System Designer | 2020 – 2024

- Directed the design and rollout of a unified design system, unifying 8 previously fragmented initiatives across 17 global locations, replacing all legacy components with a 50+ component master system, informed by a perception survey with 80+ responses.
- Co-built a scalable Figma component system using Auto Layout, variants, and reusable components, adopted across all products.
- Produced component specs, redlines, and design tokens for engineering handoff, and reviewed shipped implementation against spec to ensure fidelity.

Self-Employed: Graphic, Art Direction & Product Designer in Amsterdam | November 2018 – May 2022

- Designed UX/UI and product solutions for international clients, including website architectures and design systems.
- Developed digital products and visual identities for selected projects, including the riso-printed *Living Matters* poster series and the *MAMA* documentary film.
- Freelanced for MDPI from 2020, which led to a full-time offer joining their in-house team in May 2022.

thonik (Freelance): Art Director & Graphic Designer | Amsterdam 2018, 4 months

- Collaborated on identity and editorial design projects for international clients, including the visual identity and catalogue design for *the 2018 Shanghai Biennale at Power Station of Art*, working directly with exhibiting artists.

G.A. Brand Design (Freelance): Graphic & Digital Designer | London 2018, 7 months

- Designed print and digital publications and infographics in the financial sector using Adobe Photoshop, InDesign and Illustrator, including brand projects for *American Express – Centurion*.

Victoria Beckham (Freelance): Graphic & Social Media Designer | London 2017, 3 months

- Created campaign materials, newsletters, and social media content. Organized and supported New York Fashion Week productions.

SPIN: Junior Designer UX/UI & Brand Identity | London September 2016 – November 2017

- Prepared production-ready UI specs and motion assets for the *Samsung Fashion & Design Fund* website, building reusable UI components for its two-tier designer showcase concept, and assisted with UX/UI and identity design for *BBC* and *Nike*.
- Designed the identity system for *Saatchi Gallery Collect* in collaboration with the Creative Director, applied across large-scale signage and printed wayfinding.

Yaay: internship Information Design Intern | Basel August 2015 – January 2016

- Developed information and signage design for the city Zurich.

EDUCATION

2024 – 2025	**CAS Usability and User Experience**, FHNW Olten, Switzerland
2016	**Werkplaats Typografie**, Summer Residency at ISIA Urbino, Italy
2013 – 2015	**Bachelor of Arts in Visual Communication**, FHNW HGK Basel, Switzerland
2012 – 2013	**Vocational Baccalaureate in Design**, AGS Basel, Switzerland
2011 – 2012	**Foundation Course in Design**, Basel, Switzerland
2005 – 2009	**Business School Diploma**, WMS KVBL Reinach, Basel-Landschaft, Switzerland

SKILLS

Design & Prototyping:	Figma (Auto-Layout, Components, Libraries), Miro, Adobe CC, Wireframing, Prototyping
UX & Research:	User Research, User Interviews, Usability Testing, Customer Journey Mapping, Information Architecture, Accessibility, Analytics
Systems & Strategy:	Design Systems, UX Strategy, Stakeholder Management, AI Tools (Figma AI)
Collaboration:	Jira, Confluence, Trello, SEO, Presentation and Client Communication

LANGUAGES

German/Swiss German	Native
Cantonese	Native
English	Fluent (8 yrs abroad) & C1
French	B2
Dutch	B1
Spanish	B1
Italian	B1

VOLUNTEER WORK

German Teacher | Basel January 2026 – present
Weekly lessons for migrant women to support language development and integration.

INTERESTS

In my free time, I enjoy cooking, practising BJJ, and cycling. I love exploring cities and museums with friends, and travelling to discover architecture around the world.